

people actually pay you for your tech wizardry? (and no, we don't mean a squishy 5-Star offered as reward with a dentured grin).

Jokes aside, you need to ask yourself if your interest actually lies in IT and Support. If the answer is 'yes', then you know where to go from here. Get going!

A career awaits...

Just as you're the go-to guy for all PC problems in your neighbourhood, there's usually a person in large corporations who does essentially the same thing. Of course this usually underappreciated fellow does much more than just fix PC problems. A system administrator (usually referred to as 'SysAdmin') is responsible for the upkeep, configuration and smooth and trustworthy operation of computer systems in the professional industry. System Admins are usually placed in charge of multi-computer setups or servers. Their job is to ensure that the uptime, performance, resources, and security of the computers they manage meet the needs of the users on the server. A system administrator is given the freedom to upgrade computer components and software. He takes on the role of a technical advisor by automating routine tasks and (as and when required) writing computer programs. He's the all-round troubleshooter with a hierarchy that involves supervising a staff of Junior Administrators to provide technical support to users as and when needed.

The path of the System Administrator

Ever asked yourself 'Where do system administrators come from?'

No, no storks involved. A passion for computers and technology, and a drive to make a living off that passion. A degree in IT or CS (Engineering) is recommended, of course. Or even a degree in Computer Engineering with a natural affinity towards software and software design. Based on people we spoke to, your academic credentials should simply go on to show your interest in the field of technology and possibly management. Simply put, you don't need to be a rocket scientist, but 'What's a keystroke?' shouldn't be a question on your mind, either.

To find out more, Team Digit spoke to some system admins to tell us more about their jobs.

Syed Ibrahim is a network administrator at Alposoft Technologies Pte Ltd., Singapore. Alposoft is a company that deals with technology solutions for several companies, worldwide. Ibrahim did his Masters in Information Technology, and specialised in Computer Networking from the James Cook